NATIONAL UNIVERSITY
OF COMPUTER & EMERGING SCIENCES
LAHORE CAMPUS

SOFTEC'26
Legacy Meets Tomorrow

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Date:

17-19 April, 2026

NATIONAL UNIVERSITY OF COMPUTER & EMERGING SCIENCES LAHORE CAMPUS

SOFTEC'26 Legacy Meets Tomorrow

AI Hackathon

Register at: www.softecnu.org

Competition Overview:

The AI Hackathon is an intensive 2-phase competitive event designed to challenge participants to create innovative AI-driven solutions. This fast-paced competition tests teams' ability to rapidly ideate, design, develop, and present functional AI applications under time pressure.

Phase 1 - Development (18 Apr): Teams will design, develop, and test their AI solutions from scratch. Participants will have exactly 6hours to build working prototypes using any frameworks, libraries, or models of their choice including OpenAI APIs, Hugging Face models, custom neural networks, or other AI tools. This phase requires intense focus, collaboration, and technical execution.

Phase 2 - Pitch (19 Apr): Teams will present their completed solutions through live demonstrations and pitches to a panel of industry experts, and technical judges. Each team will showcase their working prototype, explain the problem they're solving, and demonstrate the market potential of their solution.

The hackathon emphasizes rapid prototyping, creative problem-solving, and the ability to deliver functional AI applications under extreme time constraints. Participants will experience the intensity of real-world tech sprints and startup environments.

Participants are expected to:

- Build a working AI prototype or application within 6 hours
- Attend the event on-site for the entire duration
- Bring their own computing equipment and necessary development tools
- Provide a live demonstration of their solution during pitch presentations
- The hackathon replicates the high-pressure, fast-paced nature of startup development cycles

Competition Rules:

All participants must adhere to the following guidelines:

- The competition will run for exactly 6 hours of development time.
- The theme will be revealed 30 minutes before the initiation of the competition.
- **Day 1:** Development phase begins at 10:00 AM and ends at 4:00 AM the same day.
- **Day 2:** Pitch presentations begin at 11:00 AM.

- Winner and Runner-ups will be announced in the closing ceremony of **SOFTEC'26.**
- Teams must remain on-site at the venue during the entire 6-hour development period.
- Internet access and workspace will be provided at the venue but participants are expected to bring their own backup internet connection.
- **Computing Resources:** Participants are responsible for their own computing resources. You may:
    - Use your laptop's CPU/GPU if available.
    - Use free cloud GPU platforms (Google Colab, Kaggle Notebooks) at your own discretion.
    - The organizing committee will NOT provide GPU workstations, paid cloud accounts, or computing subscriptions.
- Each presentation will be 5 minutes maximum, followed by 5 minutes of Q&A with judges.
- Teams must demonstrate a functional prototype, incomplete or non-working projects will receive reduced scores.
- All code, designs, and models must be developed during the 6-hour competition period; pre-built solutions are strictly prohibited.
- Teams may use pre-existing APIs, libraries, and frameworks, but the application logic must be original.

- It is mandatory for participants to share their codes with the organizers either on GCR or Github repositories.
- Judges' decisions are final and based on the pre-determine evaluation criteria
- Plagiarism, code theft, unethical AI practices, or any form of cheating will result in immediate disqualification.
- Teams found violating the code of conduct or competition integrity policies may be banned from future events.
- The organizers reserve the right to **modify the above-mentioned rules** and regulations without prior notice. However, a notice will be placed on top of this document. So read the document at least one day before leaving for the competitions.

Team Eligibility Criteria:

- Teams must consist of 2 to 3 members
- Open to all university students (undergraduate)
- Recent graduates (2025 or later) are also eligible
- Participants from different institutions may form teams
- Each participant can only be part of one team
- At least one team member must be present for the final presentation

Evaluation Criteria:

Projects will be evaluated by our expert panel based on the following dimensions:

- **Quality of the Idea (30%)** - Creativity and originality
- **Implementation of the Idea (30%)** - Execution quality and technical implementation
- **Potential Value to Businesses (20%)** - Business growth and commercial viability
- **Potential Community Impact (20%)** - Social impact and positive change

Registration:

- Registration fee is **PKR 5000.**
- Registration fee is **non-refundable.**

Prize Money:

- The prizes for this Competition will be distributed as follows:

Winner Prize Money	**PKR 100,000**
Runner-up Prize Money	**PKR 50,000**

For further inquiries, please do not hesitate to contact:

Heads AI Hackathon

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Note:

- **SOFTEC** reserves the right to modify any details pertaining to the competition, including but not limited to the rules, format, and eligibility criteria. All participants will be notified of any such changes in a timely manner.

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